Questions to Ask Your Doctor

Every appointment, from the first scan to six weeks after birth · Print on US Letter, or A4 with 'fit to page'

Check a box once you have asked, and write the answer down before you leave the room.

Start with the three that matter most to you — the rest can wait for the next visit.

Due date _____ **Next appointment** _____ **Who I call** _____

FIRST TRIMESTER weeks 0–13

- ☐ Which screening test do you offer — a combined blood test and nuchal translucency (NT) scan, or another one — and what is the last date I can schedule it?
- ☐ If the dating scan changes my due date, which date will my care, tests and induction dates be based on from now on?
- ☐ Which symptoms mean I should call today rather than wait: bleeding, one-sided pain, shoulder-tip pain, a fever, or vomiting I cannot keep water down?
- ☐ Which number do I call at 2 a.m., and who actually answers it?
- ☐ Am I Rh negative? If so, when is my anti-D (RhoGAM) injection due?
- ☐ What dose of folic acid and vitamin D should I take, and for how much longer? (Ask about a higher dose if your BMI is 30+, you have diabetes, or you take epilepsy medicine.)
- ☐ Which of my current medicines, supplements and herbal teas should I stop, and what should I take instead?
- ☐ My nausea is not settling — at what point do you prescribe something instead of telling me to wait it out?
- ☐ How much caffeine and alcohol are OK now, and which exercise should I stop doing?
- ☐ When is my dating scan, can my partner come in, and will I get a photo to keep?

SECOND TRIMESTER weeks 14–27

- ☐ Can you go through the anatomy scan report with me: what was measured, and was anything borderline that needs a repeat scan?
- ☐ If my placenta is low, when will it be checked again, and what would that change about the birth?
- ☐ When is my glucose test, and how do I prepare — how many hours fasting, can I sip water, and what if I am sick afterwards?
- ☐ What is my blood pressure today, and what number should make me call you rather than wait for the next visit?
- ☐ How much weight gain is right for me at my starting BMI, and how much of it belongs in this trimester?
- ☐ Are my iron and blood count being checked? If they are low, is it tablets, an infusion, and a retest when?
- ☐ Do I need the whooping cough (Tdap) and flu vaccines, and in which weeks should I have them?
- ☐ Is anything about travel, exercise, lifting or my job different for me specifically — not just in general?
- ☐ When will I feel regular movement, and when should I start watching for a pattern?
- ☐ What is my blood group and antibody result, and does it change anything in this pregnancy?
- ☐ Are there childbirth classes, physical therapy or pelvic-floor sessions I should schedule now, and how?

FOUR QUESTIONS AT EVERY VISIT

- ☐ What is my blood pressure today?
- ☐ Is there protein or glucose in my urine?
- ☐ What did you measure, and how does it compare with last time?
- ☐ When is the next appointment, and what is it for?

MY THREE QUESTIONS FOR THIS APPOINTMENT

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IF THE ANSWER IS UNCLEAR ask before you leave

- ☐ Can you say that again in plain words, and write down the name of what you found?
- ☐ What are my options, including waiting and watching — and what happens with each one?
- ☐ What would you do if this were your own pregnancy?
- ☐ Who can I call with questions once I have read the leaflet at home?

Write down what you were told, and who told you.

A prompt for your own appointment, not medical advice. Cross out anything that does not fit your care.

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THIRD TRIMESTER weeks 28–40

- [ ] When do I start counting movements, what is normal for my baby, and exactly what do I do if they slow down?
- [ ] What position is the baby in today, and at what week would we discuss turning a breech baby or planning a cesarean (C-section)?
- [ ] Which pain relief can I have here, and which options do I need to schedule or decide about in advance?
- [ ] What is your induction policy — at what week do you offer it, and can I choose extra monitoring instead?
- [ ] What are the signs of preterm labor, and do I call you, labor and delivery, or the emergency number?
- [ ] If my water breaks before contractions start, what do I do, and how long can I stay at home?
- [ ] Do you test for group B strep (GBS)? If I carry it, what changes during labor?
- [ ] I want [epidural / water birth / delayed cord clamping / skin-to-skin] — what do I need to write down, and what could stop it on the day?
- [ ] Do I need a growth scan in this trimester, and what would make you order one?
- [ ] Who can be with me at the birth, can my partner stay overnight, and what are the visiting rules?
- [ ] After the birth, who checks my mental health and when? How do I get help faster if I am not coping?

AFTER THE BIRTH first six weeks

- [ ] Who do I call about feeding pain, and when should I be seen instead of trying harder at home?
- [ ] Which bleeding, fever or pain after birth means come back now?
- [ ] What is checked at my six-week check — and what is not?
- [ ] What contraception can I use while breastfeeding, and when does it start to matter?

SPECIAL TESTS what to ask before you agree

A. Glucose tolerance test *gestational diabetes*

- [ ] How many hours do I fast, and can I drink water while I wait?
- [ ] What numbers count as high, and what happens if only one of them is over?
- [ ] If it is gestational diabetes, who manages it, and what changes first — diet, monitoring or medication?

B. Ultrasound *dating, anatomy, growth*

- [ ] What are you measuring today, and where does it sit on the growth chart?
- [ ] If something looks borderline, when is the repeat scan and who explains the report to me?
- [ ] Do I get the result in writing, and where do I find it afterwards?

C. NIPT / cell-free DNA

- [ ] What does this test screen for, and what can it not tell me?
- [ ] What is the chance of a false alarm, and which test confirms a high-risk result?
- [ ] Who gives me the result, and when — and can I opt out of finding out the sex?

D. Amniocentesis or CVS *diagnostic testing*

- [ ] What is the miscarriage risk at this clinic, as a number?
- [ ] How long until results, and is it a phone call or an appointment?
- [ ] If the result is unclear, who talks me through the options? Can I see a genetic counsellor?

ANSWERS I DO NOT WANT TO FORGET

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